Topic 32 — National Parks & Protected Areas (Advanced)

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

National Parks of Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश) | Wildlife Sanctuaries of Uttar Pradesh | National Parks of India | Marine National Parks | Important National Parks of the World | National Parks as Natural Heritage | Coastal National Parks

Sources baked in: NWDC/WII; MoEFCC; WPA 1972; UNESCO WH; NCERT; UPPCS/UPSC PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ High — NP ↔ state; UP negative geography; marine first; Yellowstone vs Corbett **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs (this topic)

- New NP / TR notifications refresh advanced PA CA — cross-check with the Protected Areas hierarchy.
- Location-match traps stay high-yield; UP has no marine PA.

32.1 National Parks of Uttar Pradesh

Identity: Dudhwa only | Lakhimpur Kheri | Terai | Tiger + rhino + barasingha

- **Uttar Pradesh has one National Park — Dudhwa** — in **Lakhimpur Kheri** on the Indo-Nepal Terai border.
- Sanctuary **1958** → National Park **1977** → core of **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve (1987)** with **Kishanpur** and **Katarniaghat** WLS.
- Habitat: Sal forest, grassland, swamp along the **Sharda (शारदा) (Mahakali)** system.
- Flagship fauna: **Bengal tiger**, reintroduced **one-horned rhino**, **barasingha** (swamp deer).
- **Pilibhit TR (2014)** and **Ranipur TR (2023)** are tiger reserves — not additional full state NPs.
- Negative geography: **Valmiki NP = Bihar**; **Sultanpur NP = Haryana**; **Corbett = Uttarakhand**.
- UP is **landlocked** — no marine or coastal NP.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q56

Dudhwa National Park (दुधवा राष्ट्रीय उद्यान) is situated in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

Options: A. Bahraich B. Lakhimpur Kheri C. Pilibhit D. Sitapur

Show answer

Ans: B

> **Logic:** “UP has two NPs — Dudhwa and Valmiki” is **false**.

32.2 Wildlife Sanctuaries of Uttar Pradesh

Identity: 25 WLS | Hastinapur largest | Chandraprabha Chandauli | Katarniaghat 1975

- UP has **25 Wildlife Sanctuaries** (official PA network) — most of the state’s in-situ protection outside Dudhwa.
- **Terai trio with Dudhwa:Katarniaghat** (Bahraich) and **Kishanpur** (Lakhimpur Kheri) — tiger, gharial, dolphin corridor.
- **Hastinapur WLS** (~2,073 sq km) is UP’s **largest**, spanning Meerut (मेरठ)–Muzaffarnagar–Ghaziabad–Bijnor–Amroha.
- **National Chambal WLS** (Agra–Etawah (इटावा) + MP–Rajasthan) — gharial, dolphin, Indian skimmer.
- **Chandraprabha WLS** is in **Chandauli** (1957; among earliest in UP).
- **Katarniaghat** was established in **1975**.
- Bird/Ramsar (रामसर) overlap includes Nawabganj, Samaspur, Sandi, Sur Sarovar, Parvati Arga, Bakhira, Saman, Sarsai Nawar, Shekha Jheel, and related wetlands.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q56

Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary is situated in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

Options: A. Sonbhadra (सोनभद्र) B. Chandauli C. Bahraich D. Lakhimpur Kheri

Show answer

Ans: B

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q36

Which Wildlife Sanctuary of Uttar Pradesh was established in 1975?

Options: A. Chambal B. Katarniaghat C. Raipur D. Kishanpur

Show answer

Ans: B

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q58

Which Ramsar sites are NOT located in Uttar Pradesh? 1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel 2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary 3. Rudrasagar Lake 4. Sultanpur National Park

Options: A. 1 and 3 B. 3 and 4 C. 2 and 3 D. 1 and 2

Show answer

Ans: B — Sarsai Nawar and Samaspur **are in UP**. Rudrasagar = **Tripura**; Sultanpur NP = **Haryana**.

All 25 Wildlife Sanctuaries of UP

#	Sanctuary	District(s)	Key fact
1	Bakhira	Sant Kabir (कबीर) Nagar	Ramsar waterfowl
2	Chandraprabha	**Chandauli**	Early WLS (1957)
3	Hastinapur	Meerut–Muzaffarnagar–Ghaziabad–Bijnor–Amroha	**Largest**
4	Kaimur	Mirzapur (मिर्ज़ापुर), Sonbhadra	Vindhyan forest
5	Katarniaghat	Bahraich	**1975**; Terai Arc
6	Kishanpur	Lakhimpur Kheri	Dudhwa corridor
7	Lakh Bahosi	Kannauj (कन्नौज)	Lake birds
8	Mahavir Swami (स्वामी)	Lalitpur	Bundelkhand
9	National Chambal	Agra, Etawah (+ MP, RJ)	Gharial/dolphin
10	Nawabganj	Unnao	Ramsar birds
11	Okhla	GB Nagar, Ghaziabad	NCR wetland
12	Parvati Arga	Gonda	Ramsar
13	Patna (पटना) Bird	Etah	Waterfowl
14	Ranipur	Chitrakoot (चित्रकूट), Banda	Ranipur TR 2023
15	Saman	Mainpuri	Ramsar
16	Samaspur	Rae Bareli	**IN UP** (Q58)
17	Sandi	Hardoi	Ramsar
18	Shekha Jheel	Aligarh (अलीगढ़)	Ramsar
19	Sohagibarwa	Maharajganj	Indo-Nepal
20	Sohelwa	Shravasti, Balrampur, Gonda	Bhabar (भाबर)–Terai
21	Sur Sarovar (Keetham)	Agra	Ramsar
22	Surha Tal	Ballia	Eastern wetland
23	Turtle	Varanasi (वाराणसी)	Gangetic turtles
24	Vijai Sagar	Mahoba	Bundelkhand lake
25	Sarsai Nawar	Etawah	**IN UP** (Q58)

> **Logic:** Samaspur and Sarsai Nawar are **in UP** — do not mark them "NOT in UP."

32.3 National Parks of India

Identity: Corbett 1936 | ~106–110 NPs | Match-list heavy | In-situ

- India's first NP is **Hailey / Jim Corbett NP (1936)**, **Uttarakhand**.
- NWDC count ~**106** NPs (~1.35% of India's area); newer notifications keep the total near **106–110**.
- **Largest NP:Hemis**, Ladakh (~3,350 sq km) — snow leopard country.
- **Most NPs:Madhya Pradesh** (~11).
- Unique facts: **Gir (Gujarat)** = only wild Asiatic lions; **Kaziranga (Assam)** = one-horned rhino stronghold; **Keoladeo (Rajasthan)** = migratory birds + Ramsar + WH.
- National Parks maintain genetic diversity (आनुवंशिक विविधता) through **in-situ conservation** (स्व-स्थाने संरक्षण).
- Negative traps: **Simlipal = Odisha** (not MP); **Sultanpur = Haryana**; zero-NP UTs include Delhi/Lakshadweep-type distractors in some lists.
- Uttarakhand has **6 NPs** vs UP's **1** (post-2000 bifurcation trap).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q90

Match: A. Dachigam B. Keoladeo C. Kanha D. Periyar with 1. Madhya Pradesh 2. Rajasthan 3. Kerala 4. Jammu and Kashmir

Options: A. 4 2 3 1 B. 2 4 1 3 C. 2 4 3 1 D. 4 2 1 3

Show answer

Ans: D — Dachigam=J&K; Keoladeo=Rajasthan; Kanha=MP; Periyar=Kerala.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q118

In National Parks, genetic diversity is maintained through—

Options: A. In-situ conservation B. Ex-situ (स्थानांतरित) conservation (बाह्य-स्थाने संरक्षण) C. Gene pool D. None

Show answer

Ans: A

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q73

Keibul Lamjao National Park (केइबुल लामजाओ) is located in which lake?

Options: A. Loktak B. Dal C. Wular D. Kolleru

Show answer

Ans: A — Manipur; only floating national park.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q62

Match: A. Indravati B. Mollem C. Kalesar D. Betla with 1. Jharkhand 2. Haryana 3. Goa (गोवा) 4. Chhattisgarh

Options: A. 4 3 2 1 B. 4 2 3 1 C. 4 1 3 2 D. 3 4 2 1

Show answer

Ans: A — Indravati=Chhattisgarh; Mollem=Goa; Kalesar=Haryana; Betla=Jharkhand.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q49 / Q58

Dachigam National Park is associated with—

Show answer

Hangul / Kashmir Stag

Which pair is NOT correctly matched?

Show answer

Simlipal National Park — Madhya Pradesh is wrong → Simlipal = **Odisha** (ओडिशा). Bandipur (बांदीपुर)–Karnataka, Manas–Assam, Periyar–Kerala are correct.

High-yield NP ↔ Leading states

National Park	State/UT	Extra fact
Jim Corbett	Uttarakhand	India first (1936); rivers **Ramganga + Kosi**
Dudhwa	Uttar Pradesh	Only UP NP; rhino rehab **1984+**
Valmiki	Bihar	NOT UP
Sultanpur / Kalesar	Haryana	Sultanpur trap
Dachigam / Salim Ali	J&K	Hangul; Salim Ali = ex-City Forest
Keoladeo Ghana	Rajasthan	Birds + WH — **not lion**
Kanha / Bandhavgarh / Panna / Van Vihar	Madhya Pradesh	Kanha hard-ground barasingha / **Bhoorsingh**; Bandhavgarh white tiger; Van Vihar = **Bhopal**
Gir	Gujarat	Asiatic lion
Kaziranga / Manas	Assam	Rhino / WH; Kaziranga rivers **Brahmaputra–Diphlu**
Periyar / Silent Valley / Eravikulam	Kerala	Elephant-tiger; **Kunthipuzha**; Nilgiri Tahr (“cloud goat”)
Bandipur / Nagarhole (Rajiv Gandhi)	Karnataka	Western Ghats

National Park	State/UT	Extra fact
Hemis	Ladakh	Largest NP
Keibul Lamjao	Manipur	Loktak floating / Sangai
Mollem	Goa	—
Indravati	Chhattisgarh	Bastar; NP 1981 / TR 1983
Betla (Palamu)	Jharkhand	Project Tiger (प्रोजेक्ट टाइगर)
Simlipal / Bhitarkanika	Odisha	Simlipal ≠ MP; saltwater crocodile
Sundarbans / Buxa	West Bengal	Mangrove + WH; Buxa Jalpaiguri
Desert / Ranthambore (रणथंभौर) / Sariska	Rajasthan	GIB; both tiger reserves; Sariska Alwar
Great Himalayan / Pin Valley	Himachal Pradesh	GHNP = **Kullu** WH 2014; Pin = Lahaul–Spiti (**not J&K**)
Rajaji / Govind / Valley of Flowers	Uttarakhand	Rajaji TR **2015**; Govind = **Tons** source; VoF alpine
Khangchendzonga	Sikkim	Mixed WH 2016
Namdapha	Arunachal Pradesh	Eastern Himalaya (हिमालय) hotspot; tropical→arctic climate belts
Gulf of Mannar	Tamil Nadu	Marine NP **1980**
Intanki / Ntangki	Nagaland	—
Guindy	Tamil Nadu	—
Papikonda	Andhra Pradesh	—
Phawngpui	Mizoram	Blue Mountain

River / species / wrong-pair keys

Stem	Correct lock
Corbett river	**Ramganga + Kosi** — not Ganga (गंगा)
Kaziranga river	**Brahmaputra / Diphlu** — not Manas
Silent Valley river	**Kunthipuzha** — not Kaveri (कावेरी)
Ghana / Bharatpur	Birds — **not lion**
Eravikulam	**Nilgiri Tahr** — not Hoolock
Hoolock Gibbon	**NE India / Assam**
Periyar	Elephant / tiger — **not Hangul**

Stem	Correct lock
Desert NP	GIB; **two districts**; habitation **exists**
Nokrek / Loktak / Namdapha	Garo (गारो) Hills / Manipur lake / Arunachal — only Nokrek–Garo matched among classic three-pair stems

> **Logic:** Kanha = **MP**. Keoladeo = **Rajasthan** (थार), not UP. Pin Valley ≠ Jammu & Kashmir.

32.4 Marine National Parks

Identity: 4 marine NPs | Gulf of Kutch first | UP = none

- India's **first Marine National Park** is **Gulf of Kutch Marine NP, Gujarat (1980/82)** — coral, mangrove, islands.
- **Gulf of Mannar Marine NP, Tamil Nadu** — coral islands, dugong; sits inside Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve (जैवमंडल आरक्षित क्षेत्र).
- **Mahatma Gandhi Marine NP (Wandoor)** and **Rani Jhansi Marine NP** are in the **Andaman** Islands.
- Do not call **Sundarbans** (सुंदरबन) or **Gahirmatha** India's first marine NP — Sundarbans is coastal mangrove NP; Gahirmatha is a **marine sanctuary** (olive ridley), not an NP.

#	Marine NP	State/UT	Fact
1	Gulf of Kutch	Gujarat	**First**
2	Gulf of Mannar	Tamil Nadu	Dugong / GoM BR
3	Mahatma Gandhi Marine	Andaman	Wandoor
4	Rani Jhansi Marine	Andaman	Ritchie's Archipelago

> **Logic:** First Marine NP = **Gulf of Kutch**, not Mannar or Sundarbans.

32.5 Important National Parks of the World

Identity: Yellowstone 1872 | Continent icons | ≠ Corbett

- **World's first National Park** is **Yellowstone NP, USA (1872)** — signed under President **Ulysses S. Grant**.
- Early peers: **Royal National Park, Australia (1879)**; **Banff NP, Canada (1885)**.
- icons: **Serengeti (Tanzania)**, **Kruger (South Africa)**, **Kakadu (Australia)**, **Galápagos (Ecuador)**, **Yosemite / Everglades / Grand Canyon (USA)**.
- Never reverse: **Yellowstone = world first**; **Corbett = India first**.

Park	Country	Fact
Yellowstone	USA	World first **1872**
Banff	Canada	**1885**
Serengeti	Tanzania	Savanna (सवाना) mega-fauna
Kruger	South Africa	Classic African NP
Kakadu	Australia	Wetland/rock art landscape
Galápagos	Ecuador	Evolution / WH

> **Logic:** World first ≠ India's first.

32.6 National Parks as Natural Heritage

Identity: UNESCO Natural WH | IUCN (आईयूसीएन) Cat II | UP has none

- National Parks protect ecosystems and species as **natural heritage** for future generations; IUCN **Category II** is the NP standard.
- UNESCO **World Heritage Convention (1972)** designates natural sites under criteria **vii–x**.
- India natural WH landscapes overlapping NPs: **Kaziranga, Keoladeo, Manas, Sundarbans, Nanda Devi + Valley of Flowers, Western Ghats (serial), Great Himalayan NP, Khangchendzonga**.
- **Keoladeo** (केवलादेव) often carries **NP + Ramsar + UNESCO WH** together.
- **Manas** was removed from the WH danger list in **2011** after recovery.
- **Uttar Pradesh has no natural UNESCO World Heritage Site** — nearest are Valley of Flowers / Nanda Devi in Uttarakhand.
- Dudhwa is an NP but **not** a UNESCO WH site.

Site	State	WH note
Kaziranga / Manas	Assam	1985 batch
Keoladeo	Rajasthan	Also Ramsar
Sundarbans	West Bengal	Mangrove WH
Nanda Devi + VoF	Uttarakhand	Alpine
Western Ghats	Multi-state	Serial **2012**
Great Himalayan	Himachal	**2014**
Khangchendzonga	Sikkim	Mixed **2016**

> **Logic:** "All UNESCO WH in India are cultural" is **false**.

32.7 Coastal National Parks

Identity: Mangrove / estuary (ज्वारनदमुख) / marine coast | East vs West | CRZ link

- **Coastal NPs** protect mangrove, estuary, delta (डेल्टा), intertidal, and reef ecosystems; all marine NPs are coastal, but not every coastal NP is a "Marine NP" label.
- Key coastal NPs: **Sundarbans (WB)**, **Bhitarkanika (Odisha)**, plus the **four (चातुर्याम) Marine NPs**.
- East coast cluster: Sundarbans, Bhitarkanika, Gulf of Mannar. West coast marine flagship: **Gulf of Kutch**.
- Coastal Regulation Zone (**CRZ** under EPA 1986 (पर्यावरण संरक्षण 1986)) restricts harmful development near sensitive coastal stretches.
- **Gahirmatha** = marine **sanctuary** (turtle rookery), not NP.
- UP has **zero** coastal NPs.

Coastal / marine park	Coast	Fact
Sundarbans NP	East	Mangrove + WH
Bhitarkanika NP	East	Mangrove / croc
Gulf of Mannar Marine NP	East	Coral islands
Gulf of Kutch Marine NP	West	First Marine NP
MG / Rani Jhansi Marine	Andaman	Island marine

> **Logic:** Coastal ≠ automatically "first marine NP."